ADVANCED POTION-MAKING

A Compendium for the N.E.W.T.-Level Student

Fifth Edition, Revised and Approved for Hogwarts School of Witchcraft and Wizardry

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Introduction

Potion-making is, and has always been, a discipline of exactitude. Where a wandless charm may forgive a sloppy gesture and a poorly pronounced incantation may still, on occasion, produce a usable result, a potion offers no such mercy. The cauldron does not care about your intentions. It cares only about heat, timing, and the precise order in which ingredients meet the boil.

This volume assumes a working knowledge of the standard ingredients catalogued in One Thousand Magical Herbs and Fungi and a basic grasp of cauldron safety as taught at O.W.L. level. Students are reminded that the instructions that follow represent the orthodox, examination-approved method for each potion. They are reliable. They are also, frequently, not the fastest or the cleverest way to arrive at the same result -- a fact that more gifted brewers tend to discover for themselves, usually by page thirty.

A note on caution: several potions in this book, if brewed incorrectly, produce effects ranging from the mildly embarrassing to the lethal. Where a step is marked with a warning, it is marked for good reason. Read every instruction twice before lighting your fire. Stir only in the direction specified. When in doubt, consult your instructor rather than your own initiative.

Chapter Seven: The Draught of Living Death

The Draught of Living Death is among the most powerful sleeping potions known to the wizarding world, inducing a state so profound that the drinker's breathing and heartbeat become nearly undetectable. It is a popular, if difficult, N.E.W.T. examination potion, and mistakes made in its brewing tend to be unforgiving.

Ingredients

One sprig of wormwood, chopped; one Sopophorous bean, cut into thin slices; two measures of standard ingredient, powdered valerian root; one sprig of asphodel; one measure of wormwood infusion, prepared separately; and a pinch of powdered root of asphodel for finishing.

Method

1. Bring your cauldron to a low simmer over a moderate flame and add the wormwood infusion.
2. Cut the Sopophorous bean with a silver knife and add the slices to the cauldron, stirring occasionally.
3. Add the chopped valerian root in two measures, then stir the potion seven times clockwise and let it stand for exactly one minute.
4. Crush the powdered root of asphodel thoroughly in a mortar before adding it, then sprinkle it evenly over the surface of the potion.
5. Add the sprig of wormwood whole, without chopping, and allow the potion to brew undisturbed for a further ten minutes.
6. Stir once more, counter-clockwise, and remove from heat. The potion should turn a pale, translucent lilac when finished correctly.

Chapter Eight: Amortentia

Amortentia is widely considered the most powerful love potion in existence. It does not, of course, create genuine love -- no potion can do that -- but it produces a powerful and dangerous infatuation. Amortentia is recognisable by its distinctive mother-of-pearl sheen and the spiralling steam it gives off, and it smells differently to each person according to what attracts them.

A Note on Safety

It is generally considered prudent, though not strictly necessary for most classroom purposes, to exercise a degree of caution when handling Amortentia, insofar as the potion may, under some circumstances, produce a mild and largely temporary infatuation effect in individuals who happen to inhale the fumes in an enclosed space for a prolonged period, although the Ministry has not classified it as a restricted substance for teaching purposes.

Ingredients

Rose thorns, powdered; ashwinder eggs, crushed; peppermint, finely chopped; a pearl dissolved in wine; and a moonstone infusion prepared the night before under a waxing moon.

Method

1. Dissolve the pearl in the wine over gentle heat, stirring until fully incorporated, which may take up to twenty minutes.
2. Add the crushed ashwinder eggs one at a time, waiting thirty seconds between each addition to avoid a sudden rise in temperature.
3. Fold in the powdered rose thorns and the chopped peppermint together, then bring the cauldron to a rolling boil for three minutes.
4. Reduce the heat and add the moonstone infusion slowly, drop by drop, stirring continuously in a figure-eight pattern.
5. Allow the potion to cool undisturbed. The finished Amortentia should be kept in a stoppered crystal bottle, away from direct sunlight.

Chapter Nine: Felix Felicis

Felix Felicis, known colloquially as Liquid Luck, is a potion of extraordinary complexity and extraordinary effect: the drinker becomes lucky for a set period, succeeding at whatever they attempt. It is toxic in excess and heavily regulated. Brewing it correctly takes six months, and the process cannot safely be rushed.

Ingredients

Squill bulb, sliced; a measure of powdered common rue; three sprigs of Ashwinder ash; a single Murtlap tentacle, finely diced; standard ingredient, ground squill root; and twelve measures of prepared base, matured for at least ninety days before use.

Method

1. Begin with the prepared base, which must first be brought to a rolling boil, then reduced to a bare simmer over the course of one full hour.

2. Add the sliced squill bulb one slice at a time, in a strict clockwise rotation around the cauldron's rim, pausing between each to let the surface settle completely.

3. Introduce the powdered common rue by first dissolving it separately in a small quantity of dragon tonic, then adding the dissolved mixture slowly over a period of no less than fifteen minutes.

4. Dice the Murtlap tentacle as finely as possible and stir it in with a copper rod, taking care to scrape the sides of the cauldron thoroughly to prevent scorching.

5. Add the Ashwinder ash in three separate sprigs, each one measured to within a hundredth of an ounce, waiting a full day between additions.

6. Allow the potion to mature, covered, for no fewer than six months, checking weekly that its colour remains a uniform molten gold.

Chapter Ten: Antidotes and Golpalott's Third Law

No study of potions is complete without a working understanding of antidotes, and no understanding of antidotes is complete without Golpalott's Third Law, which states that the antidote for a blended poison will be equal to more than the sum of the antidotes for each of the separate components.

Common Mistakes

The most frequent error among N.E.W.T. students is to attempt to identify each poisonous ingredient in a blended sample and then brew a separate antidote for each one individually, combining them at the end. This approach, though intuitive, directly contradicts Golpalott's Third Law and will not produce a working antidote. Students routinely lose significant marks for this exact mistake.

Standard Method

1. Isolate a small sample of the poison and use a standard Scarpin's Revelaspell to identify each constituent ingredient in turn.
2. Add a bezoar to the sample first and observe whether it neutralises the poison outright, which it will for most common non-magical toxins.
3. If the bezoar has no effect, calculate the antidote as a single unified compound rather than as a sum of individual antidotes, in accordance with Golpalott's Third Law.
4. Brew the unified antidote slowly, testing a small quantity on a sample of the poison before administering the full dose to a patient.
5. Always keep a bezoar within reach when working with unidentified poisons, regardless of how confident you are in your calculations.